Intraosseous Radiofrequency Ablation of the Basivertebral Nerve for Chronic Vertebrogenic Low Back Pain

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Description of Procedure or Service

Intraosseous radiofrequency ablation of the basivertebral nerve is a minimally invasive, outpatient procedure for patients with vertebrogenic pain. Intraosseous radiofrequency ablation of the basivertebral nerve is intended to be used in conjunction with radiofrequency (RF) generators for the ablation of basivertebral nerves of the L3 through S1 vertebrae.

Vertebrogenic pain is caused when the vertebral endplates degenerate and cause pain due to the damage to intraosseous nerves. The intraosseous nerve (basivertebral) weaves through the vertebral bodies. This can result in chronic low back pain.

The diagnosis of vertebral endplate pain is made using a classification scale known as Modic changes (Type 1 or Type 2). Modic changes are areas of bone marrow damage that appear on Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI).